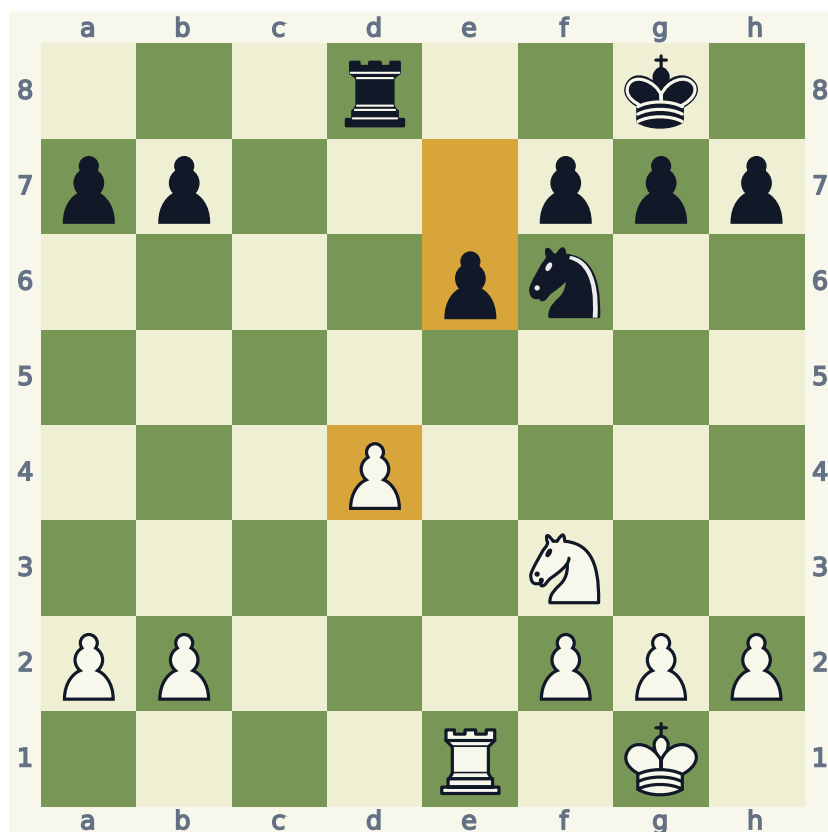


Static and dynamic compensation

Make the price of activity explicit.

Static features tend to persist: material, pawn weaknesses and enduring squares. Dynamic features depend more on time: development, initiative, exposed kings and temporary activity. A positional sacrifice trades material for lasting or sufficiently strong practical assets. Name those assets and calculate how the opponent can reduce them.

MODEL A | WHITE TO MOVE



READ THE POSITION

- White can offer the isolated d-pawn to open the e-file.
- After ...exd5, White is a pawn down.
- Re7 creates active pressure on b7 and f7, but no forced win is claimed.

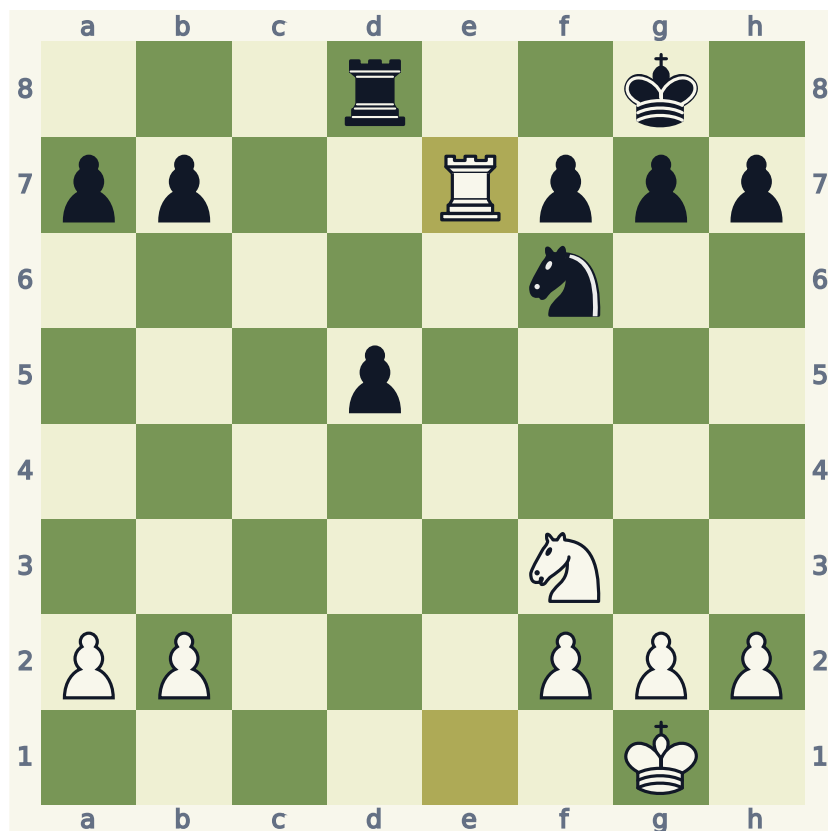
REMEMBER

- State the exact material cost.
- List durable assets and temporary threats separately.
- Test the defender's exchanges and counterplay.

Follow the logic

1. d5 exd5 2. Re7

MODEL A | POSITION AFTER THE LINE



d5

State the investment: one pawn. State the expected return: an open file and a rook on the seventh rank.

...exd5

Assume the opponent accepts and defends accurately. A sacrifice must be judged against resistance, not a cooperative continuation.

Re7

The compensation is concrete activity. Ask whether it can win a pawn back, force a concession or remain useful after exchanges.

THE OPPONENT'S PLAN

Black should seek safe exchanges, defend accessible targets and activate its own rook. If the activity disappears while the extra pawn remains, the long-term balance has shifted against the sacrificer.

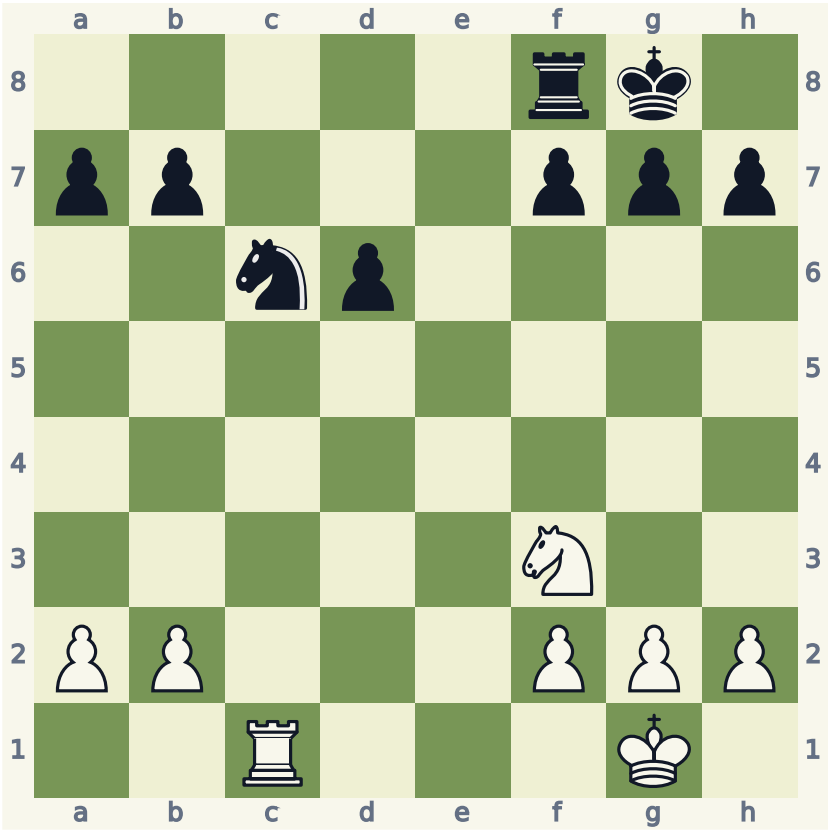
WHEN THE IDEA FAILS

Do not call compensation sufficient merely because the pieces look active. This lesson teaches how to audit a sacrifice; the sample line is illustrative and is not an engine-certified recommendation.

Find the plan

Set a timer for 6 minutes. Write the reasons, not just a move.

EXERCISE B | WHITE TO MOVE



- 1. What material has White invested after Rxc6 bxc6?
- 2. What lasting structural change did White obtain?
- 3. Is that fact alone enough to justify the sacrifice?

CHANGE ONE FEATURE

What extra evidence would make an exchange sacrifice more convincing?

YOUR PLAN, THE OPPONENT'S REPLY, AND THE RESULTING POSITION

Position code (FEN): 5rk1/pp3ppp/2np4/8/8/5N2/PP3PPP/2R3K1 w - - 0 1

Answers and transfer

1. White gave a rook for a knight. Using the usual rough values, this costs about two points of material. The exact value depends on the remaining position, but the exchange deficit is real.
2. Black's b-pawn moved to c6, creating a potential target and changing its control of squares. Black also gained a semi-open b-file for a rook. Structural damage can bring compensating benefits to its owner.
3. No. White has no rook left to attack c6 along a file, and the remaining knight needs useful entry squares. Without additional threats, king exposure or dominant squares, damaging a pawn structure is not enough by itself.

ONE ILLUSTRATIVE LEGAL LINE

1. Rxc6 bxc6

Changed feature: A secure and dominant minor piece, a dangerous passed pawn, a sustained king attack, or a concrete sequence recovering material. You must also show how these assets survive the defender's best simplifying attempts.

APPLY IT TO YOUR GAMES

For one sacrifice in a game, make two columns: assets that survive a queen trade and assets that disappear. Then calculate the strongest defensive exchange.

Self-check: Award 0-2 points per numbered answer: 1 for the relevant fact, 1 for its consequence. Add 2 for the changed-feature answer. Revisit the lesson at 5/8 or below; repeat from memory tomorrow and one week later.

Related topics: 10, 15, 24. | Reference links and notation key: 00_Start_Here.pdf.